

FLAMING SWORD

Vriesea splendens

It's hard to choose what I like most about this plant: the dominant bright sword of the bract and flower or the detailed variegation of the truly spectacular tiger-striped foliage. Together, these features make this plant a big wow for any home.

“I dazzle by day, help you breathe at night.”

Help me thrive



POSITION

Best placed in a semi-shaded position, in temperatures of around 64°F (18°C) while actively growing and no less than 59°F (15°C) in winter.



POTTING

Repot when roots grow through the bottom of the pot or circle on the inside. Use a loam-based potting mix and equal parts bark chips or perlite.



GROWTH RATE

The arching leaves of this plant can reach 2ft (60cm) tall and can spread to a width of 1½ft (45cm). It is usually a slow grower.



CARE

Add water to the central cup and refresh every 2 weeks. Water the soil when dry. Add diluted liquid fertilizer to the cup monthly when in growth.



I'll help you breathe

As a member of the bromeliad family, I breathe and produce oxygen at night, which is different to many other houseplants that produce only oxygen during the day. For this reason, I am a great bedroom plant, and when combined with other plants in different areas of the home, you will have 24-hour oxygen production.



Let's make babies

I am monocarpic, so once I have bloomed, I slowly start to die, using my energy to produce new offsets instead. These plantlets can be repotted with a free-draining compost. Alternatively, attach them to some wood or driftwood by wrapping the root ball in coconut coir fiber, filling the bundle with a bit of free-draining potting mix, and then attaching the plant to the wood with thin wire.